

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

72-hour emergency kit

PREPAREDNESS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Start with at least three days of safe water, ready-to-eat food, essential medicines, lighting and communication supplies. Include one gallon of water per person per day as a starting point, and account for pets, heat, medical needs and accessibility.

Do now.

**Inventory what you own**

01

Gather usable supplies before buying duplicates.

**Cover essentials**

02

Choose safe water, shelf-stable food, a can opener, light, radio, batteries and phone charging.

**Personalize**

03

Add medication arrangements, eyeglasses, infant needs, pet supplies, hygiene and accessible equipment.

**Maintain the kit**

04

Label dates, rotate food and water as instructed and check supplies routinely.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

If shops close today, inventory water, shelf-stable food, medicine and batteries already at home. Put them together and write down gaps. Build a usable kit in stages; a partly stocked kit is more useful than waiting for an expensive perfect one.

Watch for.

A standard checklist is only a starting point; three days may not cover a prolonged disruption.

People & practical needs.

Start with the people in the home: drinking water, medicines, infant feeding, sensory access, safe light and pet care. Choose who will carry shared items

Next decision.

Build longer-duration supplies as space and budget allow. Keep an evacuation bag separate enough to carry.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

72-hour emergency kit · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/preparedness/72-hour-kit/>